

LAURIE'S LAWS

The Doctrine of Laurie Williams

1. Know thy audience.
2. Keep it positive.
3. Just say it in plain English.
4. Define it before you use it.
5. Be consistent.
6. Who will benefit from your work?
7. Papers can always improve.
8. Make use of bulleted lists.
9. Data talk. Statistics shout.
10. Trust Yoda. Do. Or do not. There is no try.
11. Never use superlatives.
12. Their perception is your reality.
13. What are you telling people to do next?
14. If you don't believe your work, who will?
15. Nobody is above feedback.
16. Don't ask your audience to read another paper to understand yours.
17. Presentation is as important as good research.
18. Don't oversell.
19. An unpublished dissertation might as well not exist.
20. These laws are merely suggestions. The final decision is yours.

Andy Mearns
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